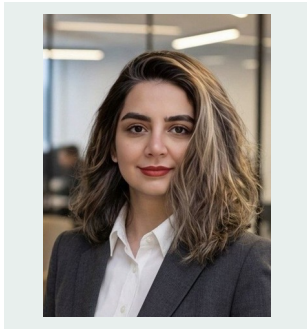




ROODABEH SEIF

AI-NATIVE PRODUCT MANAGER | UX RESEARCH | M.Sc. HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION

Responsible AI · Research to Requirements · 0 to 1 Product Discovery

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PROFILE

AI-native Product Manager with a UX research background and an M.Sc. in Human-Computer Interaction, with 4+ years in EU, EU-Japan and German federally funded digital product projects. Uses AI tools across the whole product path, from research synthesis to building working MVPs, and knows where AI belongs in a product and where it does not. Owns the full product path: user research, problem framing, requirements, prioritisation, design, implementation and validation, with clear responsible AI boundaries. Coordinated a six-partner consortium, led a student assistant team, ran roadmap and backlog in Scrum and Kanban, and builds 0 to 1 products end to end with AI-assisted tools. Background in computer science and mechatronics engineering, 5 publications.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Management: Product Strategy · Product Discovery · Problem Framing · MVP Scoping · PRD-style Requirements · User Stories & Acceptance Criteria · Feature Prioritisation · Roadmapping · Backlog Prioritisation (Kanban, GitHub) · Agile / Scrum · Decision Logs · Stakeholder Management

AI Product: GenAI / LLM Use-case Scoping · Responsible AI Requirements · AI Evals · Guardrails · Human-in-the-Loop Design · Deterministic vs. GenAI Architecture · Prompt Evaluation · Privacy by Design · Explainability · AI-assisted Prototyping

User Research: Semi-structured Interviews · Focus Groups · Ethnography · Surveys · Participatory Co-Design · Think-aloud Usability Testing · A/B Testing · Thematic / Grounded Theory Analysis · Trauma-informed Research · Mixed Methods

Design: Personas · Journey Mapping · User Flows · Information Architecture · Interaction and UI Design · Prototyping

Leadership & Facilitation: Consortium Coordination · Team Leadership · Student Mentoring and Thesis Supervision · Workshops · University Lecturing · Training Design · Train-the-Trainer · Academic Publishing

Tools: Jira · Confluence · Notion · Miro · Figma · Lovable · ChatGPT · GitHub · MAXQDA · Adobe CC (incl. Adobe XD)

Technical: Python · Unity · HTML / CSS · MATLAB · C++ · Linux · Docker · Bash

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PhD Candidate | Human-Computer Interaction

2026 – present

University of Siegen | Siegen, Germany

- Doctoral research on participatory digital design for migrant mental wellbeing.

Research Associate (Wissenschaftliche Mitarbeiterin) | Product, UX Research & Project Coordination

10/2021 – 12/2025

University of Siegen | Information Systems and New Media | Siegen, Germany

- Research-to-product work across EU, EU-Japan and BMBF/BMFTR-funded, multi-partner consortium projects.
- **CrossComITS (BMBF/BMFTR, 05/2023 – 12/2025), project coordinator:** Coordinated a six-partner consortium (stakeholder management) and led both the University of Siegen team and the partner team in Scrum-based agile iterations.
- Led the student assistant team for the University of Siegen part of the project and coordinated testing cycles with student assistants and partners.
- Maintained the roadmap and decision logs and owned backlog prioritisation on a Kanban board in GitHub.
- Led product discovery with 3 user groups (older adults, migrants and refugees, youth) through interviews, surveys, workshops and participatory learning sessions (Smartphone Café).
- Translated interviews, fieldwork, workshops and usability tests into personas, journey maps and PRD-style requirements with user stories and acceptance criteria for a social open educational resources (OER) learning platform.
- Delivered 3 learning products: a cybersecurity board game, metaphor flashcards and an OER learning platform. Ran an A/B test of flashcard formats (text vs. visual metaphor); the result became the product decision: metaphor plus a short explanation.
- Co-authored 2 publications (ACM PDC 2026; Springer VS 2026 as first author, on community-based cybersecurity education, OER and train-the-trainer models) and contributed to grant proposals.
- **NEBULA (BMBF, 05/2023 – 12/2025), UX researcher:** Researched trust in AI with vulnerable groups: 7-person focus group, interviews, 6 months of ethnography with older adults and youth workshops in 3 municipalities.
- Synthesised the findings into responsible AI requirements for a misinformation detection tool: explainable, contestable, multilingual and human-controlled. The requirements fed the development backlog of the consortium in Jira. Published as a Springer VS chapter (2026).
- Built an own interaction prototype from the documented requirements: URL, text and image input with visible privacy limits, explanation of uncertainty and inspectable evidence.

- **eVITA (EU-Japan, 12/2021 – 05/2023), UX researcher and designer:** Improved the existing ABC App in Unity, a cognitive training app driven by the NeU fNIRS brain activity sensor, in the University of Siegen Living Lab: requirements, prototypes and implementation changes.
- Designed the Bo App for the same sensor end to end: planned and ran interviews, real-time participatory co-design (online and in person), observation and think-aloud usability tests with 7 older adults aged 60 to 80, in 12 sessions (about 22 hours) and 4 design rounds.
- Prioritised usability problems, translated evidence into requirements, and designed, tested and retested interactive prototypes in Figma and Adobe XD.
- Result: participants could set up and use the sensor with the Bo App alone. Independent setup rose from 25% in the first test to 100% in the final retest (1 of 4 to 3 of 3 users), users needing assistance fell from 75% to 0%, 80% of high-priority usability issues (8 of 10) were resolved, with 0 navigation issues in the final retest. Published at OzCHI 2024.
- Worked with European and Japanese partners on multilingual design for German, French, Italian and Japanese users.
- **Surveillance Beyond Borders (2024 – 2025), lead researcher and prototype owner:** Led trauma-informed research end to end with 37 semi-structured interviews in two phases (23 + 14) on digital safety under transnational repression, analysed with Grounded Theory-informed thematic analysis.
- Derived five empirical dynamics and an "Ecology of Digital Survival" framework, and designed a working prototype with five safety concepts (Identity Splitter, Trust Circles, Metadata Minimizer, Neutral Nudges, Risk-Adaptive Posting Coach). First-author manuscript prepared for academic review.
- **Mentoring:** Mentored students in their master theses and study projects.

Business & Data Analyst Intern | Cybersecurity

12/2020 – 07/2021

Operatis Business Technology Consulting | Germany

- Analysed business processes and translated operational needs into structured requirements, workflows and improvement opportunities.
- Supported the evaluation, configuration, testing and implementation of IT and business software; researched technologies and vendors.
- Prepared, cleaned and validated data for integration and migration; processed knowledge-graph and JSON data (JSON-to-RDF) on Linux with Bash, and used Docker for environment setup and testing.
- Prepared project documentation, status overviews and decision-support material, and coordinated tasks between clients, consultants and technical stakeholders.

Lecturer & Digital Competency Trainer | Computer Science

10/2015 – 12/2017

Islamic Azad University | Tehran West and Karaj branches, Iran

- Taught undergraduate courses in data structures, computer networks, Photoshop and technical English.
- Designed and ran digital competency workshops for 200+ students per year.

SELECTED PRODUCT PROJECTS

Retune | Wellbeing | 0 to 1 Product | ongoing: Independent, self-funded habit app for people living through crisis, illness or migration. Owned everything from research to implementation, with no separate developer or designer.

- Product strategy: problem framing, product principles, MVP scope, feature prioritisation, requirements and AI boundaries; built the Persian (right-to-left), mobile-first functional MVP with Lovable.
- Validation: observation, 62-person survey, 8 follow-up interviews, 7 usability tests and a 4-week pilot with 18 users. Results: 86% onboarding success, 78% correct understanding of per-activity privacy.
- AI: scoped an AI reflection feature (deterministic vs. GenAI architecture, guardrails) and evaluated it offline on 60 cases before any release: 98% numeric consistency, 0 fabricated metrics.

Ghesse Khaneh | Interactive Storytelling | 0 to 1 Product: Independent, self-funded platform that supports facilitators before, during and after interactive storytelling sessions with children. Owned everything from research to implementation.

- User and stakeholder research, product concept, information architecture, facilitator workflow and session journey, feature prioritisation, interaction and UI design.
- Built a bilingual (Persian / English) responsive web-app prototype; AI assistant designed as a concept with human-in-the-loop control.

DARA | Workplace Wellbeing | 0 to 1 Product | 2026: Own idea, owned end to end: research, problem framing, privacy model, feature set, UX and interaction design.

- Built a functional browser demo with Lovable in one day: employee view (check-in, conversation coach, reflection, personal journey) and manager view based only on aggregated, anonymised team patterns. Concept stage, not yet user-tested.

TEACHING & COMMUNITY

Meditation Instructor

2025 – present

Online | Persian-speaking community

- Online meditation sessions on mindfulness and emotional wellbeing, based on 13+ years of personal practice.

Private Tutor

2022

Germany

- Mathematics and English for primary-school students with different learning needs and cultural backgrounds.

EDUCATION

Master of Science (M.Sc.) Human-Computer Interaction University of Siegen, Germany Master Thesis: How older adults use measures of brain activity in real life: A Design Case Study Methods: Design Case Study · Co-Design · Interviews · Usability Testing · Qualitative Analysis	2019 - 2022
Master of Science (M.Sc.) Mechatronics Engineering Islamic Azad University, Qazvin, Iran Research: Mobile robot path planning with RRT* in dynamic environments, implemented and simulated in MATLAB; published in IJISA 2015 as first author	2011 - 2014
Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) Computer Science Payame Noor University, Iran	2005 - 2010

CERTIFICATES & TRAINING

AI Consulting & Integration Bootcamp Ironhack	10/2026 - 12/2026 (ongoing)
Microsoft AI Product Manager Professional Certificate Coursera	in progress
Enterprise Product Management Fundamentals Certificate	completed
Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design Certificate	completed
DCitizens Summer School (EU Horizon) Lisbon, Portugal	2024

PUBLICATIONS

• Mediating Digital Security: Participatory Learning with Older Adults in Smartphone Café Sessions. ACM PDC 2026. Second author. DOI 10.1145/3796624.3796644 • Building Bridges, Not Barriers. Book chapter, Springer VS, 2026, pp. 151–180. First author. DOI 10.1007/978-3-658-52212-4_7 • User-Centred AI for Combating Misinformation with Vulnerable Groups. Book chapter, Springer VS, 2026, pp. 227–252. Second author. DOI 10.1007/978-3-658-52212-4_10 • Prototyping and Evaluating Bo App: A Brain Measurement Device as a Feedback Tool for Cognitive Training. OzCHI 2024, ACM (published 09/2025). DOI 10.1145/3726986.3727033 • Mobile Robot Path Planning by RRT* in Dynamic Environments. IJISA, 2015. First author. • Surveillance Beyond Borders: digital safety under transnational repression. Manuscript prepared for academic review. First author. ORCID 0009-0008-6459-9637	
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LANGUAGES

Persian Native | English C2 | German B2 (B1 certified)

INTERESTS

Flute · Watercolour · Photography and Film · Hiking · Meditation · Cooking